Next Life Soundtrack – A Program

By Billy Joel, Buddy Wakefield and Terence Kawaja

We Didn't Start the Fire by Billy Joel

Birth control, Ho Chi Minh, Richard Nixon back again

Moonshot, Woodstock, Watergate, punk rock

Begin, Reagan, Palestine, terror on the airline

Ayatollah's in Iran, Russians in Afghanistan

We didn't start the fire

It was always burning, since the world's been turning

We didn't start the fire

No, we didn't light it, but we tried to fight it . . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Billy Joel
Book: Storm Front, Pg 15-25
ISBN: 978-0793502615
Publisher: Hal Leonard Corporation
Date (Month/Year): April 1990

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INTRODUCTION

Artist Billy Joel said that the ultimate purpose of the song We Didn't Start the Fire was to neither provide a complete account nor pass blame; what he really wanted to do was help young people realize that there are lessons in the past that might help us work through the present and plan for the future.

Buddy Wakefield takes that concept one step further and in reverse when he wrote: "Years from now, the enlightened civilization ahead of us will stare bewildered at our lethal masculinity and say, But each one, when he was running, tied bows to the top of his feet." (From a Choir of Honest Killers)

Where do you live your life? In the past . . . the present . . . or with an eye on the future?

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Next Life Soundtrack by Buddy Wakefield

Having pumped panic buttons and pedal metal down the

throats of freeways

and crashed like heavy glass ashtrays into our own homes

broadside

with department store force and a gas can,

distended stomachs and God's holes. . .

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Having shown off our momentum for yawning
as a clever way to denigrate deeds of kindness. . .
Having created enough minimum wage faith
to distract orphans from the exit rows
then thrown holding pattern parties in their honor
only to present each other with our own names on gold
plaques bolted
to a fountain of toll booths used to dressed up up in our go
go
go and gone uninterrupted
by the signs that serve to encourage calming down,
it is good to know I have at least been loosening my grip on
the expectation
that our thumbs will necessarily oppose each other
in the next life.

There is a next life
and it is my understanding we will not necessarily
be binge-drinking bros
wearing Greek lamp shades paying for friendships
based on how our breath smells.
I will not necessarily find myself rationalizing with computer

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gamers
and overly polite customer service robots
about how much life is lost on alternative realities
or how much violence peaceful consumers cause.
The results of our language cannot be programmed.
There is no proper way to hide the rampage with whom we
have been banking.
There are no words thick enough to conceal the
transparencies
in these stories we have crafted

out of loopholes and nothin' but net.

The next life is being offered to us daily
via live streaming satellite by entitled white rabbits and
tragedy addicts
dragging their
fingernail
file
cabinets
across records of the damage my nerves have done.
You inglorious preachers of a sensational game.

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Sensations and games are at the root of why we are
walking so inefficiently,
warped 45's with credit card swagger charging up a sad sad path
like Ray Charles singing Seven Spanish Angels
to the bottom of the barrel
in
broad daylight. Stop congregating in the valley just because an echo
sounds good when it agrees with itself
A trajectory of misery -- at this point -- seems intentional.
We have all the information we need to see clearly.
We are no longer unaware toddlers on the landscape of consciousness.
It is no longer cute to crap ourselves.

Get the sticky off your buns and roll with me.
Brush the hair from your eyes and comb over.
Stop paying the dentist for a night guard if it's still allowing your jaw to
pulverize the truth.
The truth is: You feel fine, right now.

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We are a point of complete, not a soundtrack to the next life.
The future
gets no say in who we are.
Settle your debt and logout.
Thank you
for laughing at the joke several lines ago about sticky buns.
That was sweet. This is nuts.
Listen. . .

Having listened
to the parentheses of passive aggression
and made far too much bracket in response,
incriminating ourselves as sucker punches and suckerfish, soaker hoses
and preying on the dead weight
of fashion-forward food for overpopulation,
having inflicted the most amount of pleasure with the least harm done
then called it progress,
I am still, without fail, eligible to remind us that there is a reason

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the future gets so agitated by our advances.
We are not built to barge ahead of ourselves in false fast-forward on a
flat fifth wheel made out of spokespeople for progress
who fly off the handle whenever anyone taps the breaks.
Throw it in park.

Gauge the pressure.
Renunciation is not a frigid concept.
It is okay to abandon the tackle practice
of having and crashing and having and crashing
through this circuit board of carrier pigeons carrying torch carriers
over an orchestra of strung-out sixteenth notes
composed with a matchstick that struck out and broke off but did not
burn up.
If the next life keeps finding us in these uncomfortable positions
they might mistake us for honest.
How honest is it that we drink until we are dehydrated?
If my throat turns into carbonated leather

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and you hang me like a lucky foot from the rearview mirror
while barreling down the freeway, toll booth after toll booth, in a heavyglass ash tray, wondering how the hell freeways got so expensive, remember this:

The White Rabbit is said to be a symbol of human beings
who are pompous and belittling toward anything they deem less valuable than themselves, yet they grovel to accommodate anyone from whom they stand to gain.
To what end are you gaining?
I'm not speaking to our governments,
I'm speaking to the way we govern ourselves.
Make your stopwatch live up to its name.
We are not late for an important date,
we have simply shown up too early for the next life and forgot to knock,
forgot that the future doesn't want us to arrive.
It knows that if we do, it dies.
As if people on stilts really need you to offer them more gravity.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Buddy Wakefield
Book: Learn then Burn 2: This Time It's Personal (Pg 69-73)
ISBN: 978-1938912504
Publisher: Write Bloody Publishing
Date (Month/Year): Jan 2015

TRANSITION

Baby Boomers considered "We Didn't Start the Fire" a soundtrack documenting their lives. But what about Gen Xers, Millennials and Zoomers? Where's our soundtrack? Events are spiraling rapidly – Let's take just a quick look at the year 2022.

We Didn't Start the Fire: 2022 EDITION
by Terence Kawaja

Jeff Epstein, Uyghur mess, Fentanyl, COVID stress
Royal hush, Metaverse, election lies keep getting worse
Crypto scams, tech stock crash, Canadian truckers make a splash
Lockdown driving us insane, trouble in Ukraine

Work from home, supply chain, Oscar slap, sanction pain
Gender roles, Ukraine aid, say goodbye to Roe v. Wade

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Russian war, KBJ, Fed rate hikes, don't say gay
Putin bash, Uvalde, tourists on a travel spree

Saudi golf, streaming ads, Latins voting for comrades
Pipeline bomb, Chairman Xi, Tim Cook says it's privacy
Chip wars, antitrust, Greg Norman, Elon Musk
$5 buck gas, going green?, Britain loses its loved Queen

Interest rates, crypto pain, web3 mania insane
Recession fears, SPACs don't work, Boris such a Tory jerk
World War 3?, Taiwan threats, Rocketman, hijab protests
Lettuce wins, Elon's sink, democracy at the brink

Kanye hate, election lies, tech layoffs on the rise
Russians lose, Bannon jail, Elon's Twitter product fail
Crypto crash, FTX, US young men get no sex
Lula wins, trade dispute, MAGA Trumpists get the boot

Billy Joel's 80s song covered issues decades long
This parody so true only cites 2022
More change is on the way, consternation's here to stay
Election 2024, I swear I can't take any more

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Billy Joel Reprieve *(Singing)* We didn't start the fire

It was always burning, since the world's been turning

We didn't start the fire

But when we are gone

It will still burn on, and on, and on, and on, and on, and on,

and on, and on

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Terence Kawaja
ISBN: On-Line Transcript
Publisher: Youtube.com
Date (Month/Year): Nov 15, 2022

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Tnao981OyVw

* ***We Didn't Start the Fire by Billy Joel***
Music and Lyrics
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eFTLKWw542g

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